

Christiaan Verhoef

Deployment Strategist | Forward-Deployed AI | Regional Team Builder

Baarn, Netherlands +31 6 30 18 47 43 christiaan_gerardo@hotmail.com linkedin.com/in/christiaanverhoef

SUMMARY

Field deployment engineer turned innovation lab builder: shipped complex systems solo in hostile environments (oil and gas, 4 countries, no internet, no support line), then built the innovation teams and labs that make technology stick inside organizations. 15+ years in forward-deployed, cross-functional roles requiring technical depth, enterprise stakeholder management, and the ability to solve problems that aren't in the manual. Dutch-native, English near-native, based in Baarn NL. Ready to build a forward-deployed AI team in the Benelux from zero.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Forward-Deployed Execution

Enterprise Stakeholder Management

Regional Team Building (0 → 1)

AI Stack Deployment

Technical Communication to C-Suite

Dutch / English bilingual

Async-native / Remote

API Integration

Scrum / Agile (15+ yrs)

WORK EXPERIENCE

KONGSBERG

2012 -- 2013

Field Service Engineer -- BI Deployments (BP, Statoil) | Kristiansand, Norway

- Solo deployment engineer across four countries (Jordan, Oman, Houston, Azerbaijan) in oil and gas safety-critical environments. No internet access, no support line. Owned the full deployment lifecycle end-to-end: hardware, software, data configuration, documentation, user training, and stakeholder negotiation.
- Jordan (BP):** Database failed to deploy despite correct procedure. Deployed a dead-switch in the infrastructure room to isolate client-side networking fault. Client administrator refused to acknowledge the problem; dead-switch proved it conclusively. Resolved on day three, on schedule.
- Azerbaijan (BP):** Subcontractor withheld data that BP had contractual right to receive. Read the full BP contract, identified the specific clauses, confronted the GeoServices division manager directly. Data shared within one day. No formal authority, no escalation available.
- Houston (BP):** Recognized the assignment was underutilizing available capability. Trained a local engineer to take over and volunteered for urgent Azerbaijan redeployment. This is what forward-deployed looks like from the inside: solve your current problem, then go find the next one.
- Offshore Survival Training (HUET) certified. Deployed to remote oil platforms and live production environments.

Windesheim University of Applied Sciences

Jan 2020 -- Present

Project Manager -- AI Research Infrastructure | Zwolle, Netherlands

- Built and operate self-hosted AI infrastructure (Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase, Docker/Linux) for university researchers and students. Design, deploy, maintain -- solo. This is practical AI deployment, not advisory.
- Value Chain Hackers:** AI-powered compliance tooling for enterprise-grade supply chain audits (CSRD, EUDR, CSDDD). Principal investigator, program manager, and technical lead. Presented to executive teams at partner organizations.
- Spark! Living Lab:** Built from zero -- Beer Game blockchain simulation platform, deployed, external partners onboarded, multi-year program running.
- Co-authored grant proposals; approximately EUR 2M in innovation funding facilitated.

Aeres Hogeschool

2021 -- 2022

Lab Manager -- Regional Innovation Hub | Dronten, Netherlands

- Built a new innovation lab from zero in an institution with no prior practice: merged 8 courses into one sprint-based innovation track in under 2 months, hired student and industry participants, structured the team, shipped results. Two operating startups as output.
- Veles Farming: identified a student project worth backing, became seed investor and mentor, guided to operating agri-tech company in Slovakia (EUR 2M funding).

Tonomy Foundation

2021 -- Present

Co-Founder | Amsterdam and Remote

- Built open-source identity platform from zero. Defined technical architecture, led partner development and ecosystem strategy, ran 2-week sprint cycles with distributed European team. Product reached W3C CCG recognition stage.
- Managed external partner relationships across the Netherlands, UK, and Germany. Presented at international blockchain/identity forums.

Social Chicken / The Fork / ROC Midden Nederland

2016 -- 2022

Freelance Technical Advisor and Enterprise Trainer | Amsterdam

- Delivered enterprise blockchain and AI training to corporate and government clients across Benelux (2bSMART). Explained complex technical concepts to non-technical executive audiences.
- Technical due diligence for pre-seed startup; investment recommendation; 4x exit achieved.

WDS Global

2008 -- 2009

Technical Support Engineer (3rd Line) | Poole, England

- Progressed from 1st to 3rd line support within 2 months. Became informal Dutch team leader within 3 months without formal authority. Cleared a 10,000-email backlog by redesigning workflows. Proposed customer education video concept that reached HTC Tokyo; later adopted independently.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor Business IT & Management -- Hogeschool van Amsterdam

2010--2014

Grade: 8.7/10. Thesis: simulation-based learning for complex system operators (KONGSBERG). Minor: E-discovery and digital forensics.

Certifications: Offshore Survival/HUET, Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I), PSPO I, Prince2, ITIL, Oracle 11g

Languages: Dutch (native), English (near-native, B2+)

AI/Dev tools: Flowise, n8n, OpenWebUI, Supabase, Docker, Linux, PostgreSQL, GitHub CI/CD, Python (API integration level)